



Wi-Fi routers:

Basics: A, B & G routers are old and slow. N-Routers are capable of handling higher speeds. Check on that if you have a speed issue. Also remember: if you want to make use of your N-Router's full potential, your computer should have a wireless N-Card as well. The next thing you need to use is a little bit of common sense with respect to the placement of your router. Try placing it closest to where you use your laptop the most. Once you've done that, please remember, putting behind the fridge or cabinet will, definitely, hinder your performance. Yes, I agree that it seems ridiculously basic a suggestion, but you'd be surprised how many people place their routers out of sight just because it doesn't match their 18th-Century Rajasthani table.

Your Wi-Fi Channel: The chances are that the default settings for your router to find a channel are set on auto. If that is the case, the reason your speed's down could be a result of having too many people broadcasting their own Wi-Fi in your vicinity. Fixing this is easy. There's a free program called InSSIDer (<http://www.metageek.net/products/inssider/>) which can be used to determine the ideal channel for your router.

These programs also help improve your router's QoS (Quality of Service). QoS is a broad phrase referring to a collection of networking technologies



inSSIDer

and techniques. The idea behind having QoS is to provide a guarantee that a network will deliver predictable results to the best of their ability. Elements within the framework of QoS usually include throughput (bandwidth), delay (latency), uptime (availability) and error rate.

Electrical Interference: Some devices, like cordless phones and microwave ovens can play havoc with your wifi signal. Keeping these items away from your router would help in the overall performance of your internet connection.

DD-WRT: Disclaimer: This is a specific fix for routers supported by the DD-WRT open-source firmware. So before trying this, find out of your specific router is supported, or you may end up bricking your router.

Most routers don't use their full potential because of the firmware restrictions on them. This tends to affect their overall functionality. To overcome this problem, there exists a Linux-based firmware for wireless

routers and wireless access points called DD-WRT. It is a third-party firmware designed specifically to replace the original on some commercial routers. Alternative firmware like DD-WRT may offer features and functionality sets that differ from the original one it replaces.

Instructions: First thing to do is to go to <http://www.dd-wrt.co.in/site/support/router-database>, (1) Type your router's model number in the search bar and (2) check if your router supports the firmware. If it does, download the corresponding file off the same website.

The installation of DD-WRT depends on your router, but the general instructions are usually the same:

- Log into your router's admin page. Consult router's manual for admin address.
- Go to the Admin section and select Firmware Upgrade.
- Select your DD-WRT upgrade file and keep the router plugged in until the upgrade is done.

After DD-WRT installs, reconnect to your network over Ethernet or Wi-Fi (with a new network SSID of dd-wrt) and visit your admin page. In most cases it will still live at the same address of its predecessor. DD-WRT will ask you to choose your own username and password. Older versions may request one, which by default is root/admin (which you should change to your own after this). When you login, you will see the DD-WRT admin page. Welcome to your new router. One thing we haven't mentioned in the segment above is the use of Internet Booster software. Though reputed to do a good job of improving your internet connectivity, most of the effective do so in specific ways; like fixing your connection's latency or bandwidth. But let that not deter you from mailing us your queries at sos@thinkdigit.com.

Before reading any article that tells you how to fix your system, remember, cover whatever bases you can cover on your own before relying on people you assume are more experienced at this than you are..

Coming back to the internet issue, make sure you read up on service providers. What worked for you in Delhi may not necessarily have the same service in Mumbai or Bangalore. ISPs change by the city, and this is with respect to all kinds of connections be it Broadband, USB dongles, 3G data cards or even a 56,000kbps dial-up.

ASUS
IN SEARCH OF INCREDIBLE

FAST Networking Solutions
FAST • EASY • STABLE



Wireless Router 2013
A trademark of Ziff Davis, Inc. Used under license



RT-AC68U Dual-band Wireless-AC1900 Router
World's **Fastest** - For Those Who Run Ahead

33% Faster Speed

150% Wider Range

30-Sec Setup



* Conditions Apply | All Specifications are subject to change without notice. Product availability may vary by region.
www.asus.in | Toll Free No. 1800-2090-365 | For Feedback Email reachus@asus.com or Log on to www.asuservice.com